



while typing, it isn't the keyboard that attracts unwanted attention. Also, it's magnetic, too, so as I said, when you want to use this machine as a normal laptop, the keyboard snaps right onto the bottom screen. The trackpad is smooth and responsive, though I found myself reaching out to touch the screens to scroll through pages more often than I expected.

PERFORMANCE: IS PANTHER LAKE ENOUGH FOR A DUAL-SCREEN SETUP?

Under the hood, the Asus Zenbook Duo UX8407 is powered by the Intel Core Ultra X9 388H, which is part of the new Panther Lake family. This is paired with 32 GB of LPDDR5 RAM and an integrated Intel Arc B390 GPU. Since there's no dedicated NVIDIA or AMD chip inside, I was curious to see if it would struggle with my typical workflow. It didn't. In fact, it handled everything I threw at it with ease. To give you an idea of the muscle here, this chip features 16 cores and 16 threads with a boost clock of up to 5.1 GHz. But the real secret sauce for the future is the NPU,

which now pushes up to 50 TOPS. Of course, in the present times, we're still in the early days of AI features actually being useful. But at the same time, having that much dedicated power for background tasks means the main CPU can stay focused on what you're actually doing on the machine.

I ran a few benchmarks to see where it sits:

- **Cinebench R23:** 15,586 (multi-core) / 2,093 (single-core)
- **TimeSpy:** 7,079
- **Night Raid:** 43,426
- **FireStrike:** 12,374
- **Wild Life Extreme:** 2,685

In real-world terms, it feels every bit as snappy as you'd expect from any high-end ultrabook. When you compare it to the previous generation's Meteor Lake chips, Panther Lake feels like a proper step up in fluidity. I never felt the performance slow down, even with both screens active, running different workflows at the same time. The 32 GB of RAM plays a huge role here, especially when you're multitasking across two displays. In fact, I even played some Tekken 7 to kill time, and it ran perfectly

without any hiccups or frame drops. The new Arc graphics architecture in Panther Lake is surprisingly capable. Of course, you won't be playing heavy AAA titles at max settings, but it's more than enough for casual gaming and smooth 4K video playback. For writing, browsing, and heavy multitasking, it flies. The PC Mark 10 Work score of 7,385 confirms that it's more than capable enough for a demanding user.

THE 99WH BATTERY HAS SOLID ENDURANCE

Asus managed to fit a 99Wh battery into this 14-inch chassis, which is massive. In the PC Mark 10 battery test, it lasted about 802 minutes, which is roughly 13.5 hours. Obviously, using both OLED screens at high brightness will drain the battery faster, but in laptop Mode, the endurance is fantastic. Even using both screens for a full workday, I rarely had to put the machine on charge before the day was done.

FINAL VERDICT

The Asus Zenbook Duo UX8407 is a specialist tool, but it's one that actually works. It's going to appeal a lot to folks who feel limited by a single screen but need to stay mobile. However, given its price tag, it will be compared to other premium laptops, like the MacBooks, Dells and HPs. But, neither of those can give you this much screen real estate.

—Aman Rashid

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core Ultra X9 Processor 388H 2.1 GHz | NPU: Intel NPU upto 50TOPS | GPU: Intel Arc Graphics | Display: 14.0-inch 3K OLED panels | Aspect Ratio: 16:10 | Refresh Rate: 144Hz | Brightness: 500 nits | RAM: 16/32GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 512GB / 1/2 TB M.2 NVMe PCIe 4.0 SSD | Battery: 99 WHrs, 2-cell Li-ion | Power Supply: TYPE-C, 100W Ultra mini AC Adapter

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